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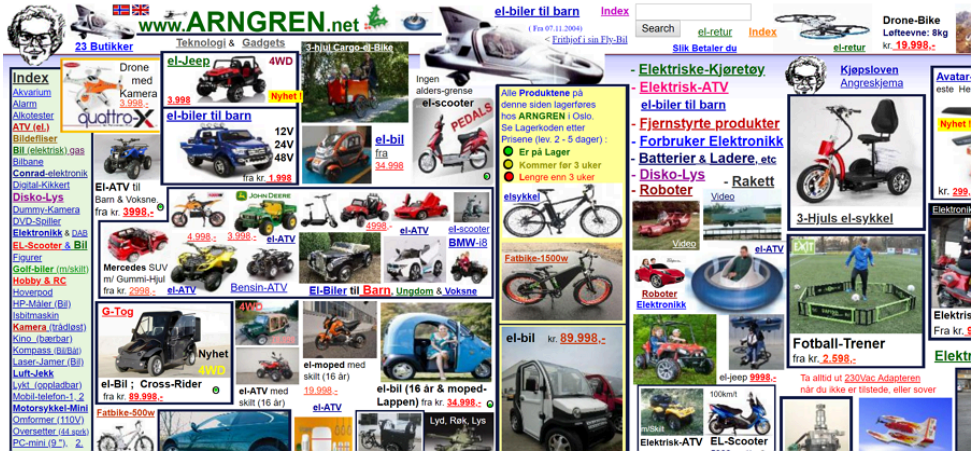
Instructions: Research about the following Components of Web Design.

1. Grids

Grids act as an invisible margin on the sides and as a ruler on webpages. With this, the contents inside the webpage will be placed neatly and with structure instead of being randomly scattered around the page. This makes it easier for the users to navigate through the webpage and have an intuitive interface that contributes to a good user experience (UX).

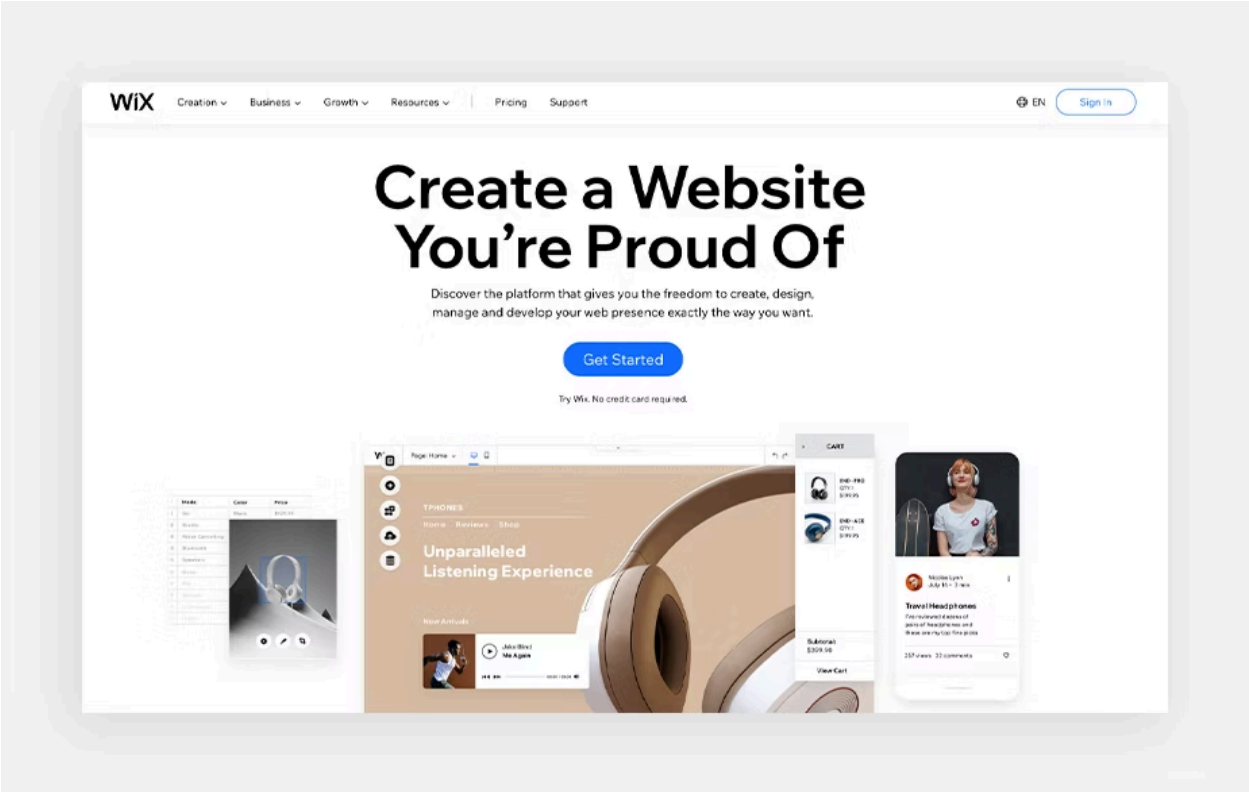
When using grids, it is a best practice to design the webpage to be responsive. This means that the webpage layout should be adaptable to different devices; if there is a change to the set resolution of a device or if the screen size changes, the number of columns of a grid should also change to fit the new size of the screen.



This example **badly illustrates** the usage of grids. The webpage feels cluttered and users are not able to intuitively navigate through the website. This may drive the website visitors out of the site and leave due to the overwhelming amount of information displayed all at once.

2. Call to Action

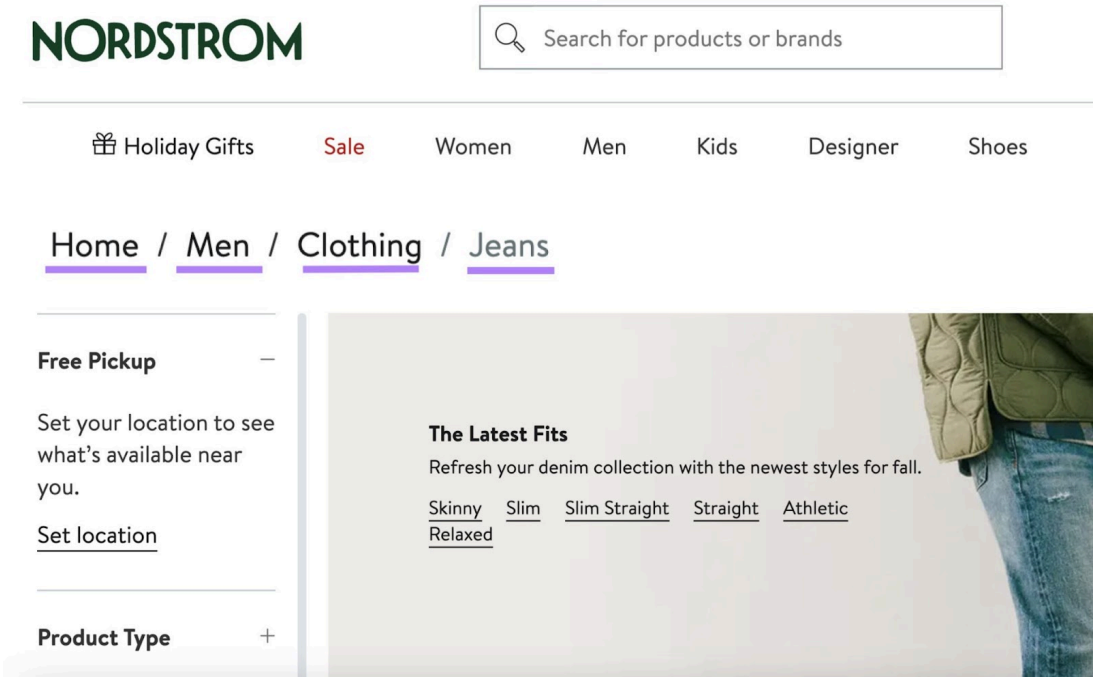
Call to Actions (CTAs) are buttons or links that inform the user of what to do next in the webpage. These are short, and clear words or instructions that guide the users to avoid confusion. Some common examples of CTAs are: “Learn More.”, “Get Started”, and “Create an Account”.



This example **perfectly illustrates** the use of a Call to Action. The button clearly sends the appropriate message of what it does. Moreover, this button effectively guides the user to the next step of creating their own website.

3. Breadcrumb

The term “breadcrumb” in web design refers to the feature of webpages that provides the users the information of where they currently are in a webpage. This allows them to go back to previous pages with ease. Usually, breadcrumbs are arranged in a way based on the webpages’ hierarchy.

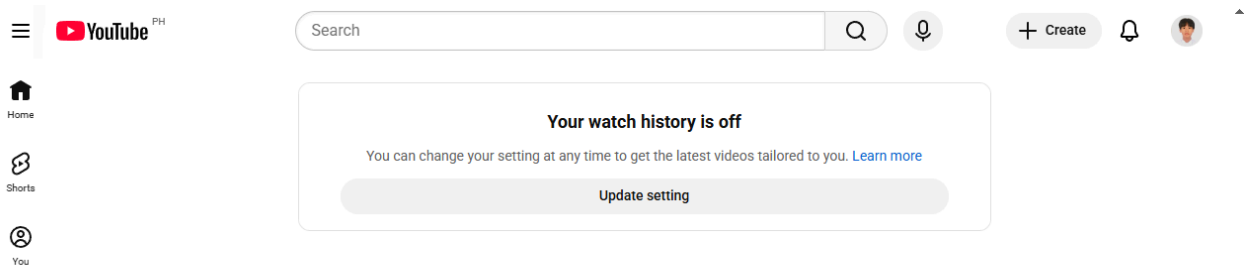


This example perfectly illustrates **good** usage of breadcrumbs in web design. The used breadcrumbs effectively inform the user where they currently are in the website. Along with this, the user is able to navigate the previous webpages they have visited or clicked on.

4. Search Bar

Search Bars in web design provides users the ability to search or type in keywords that they want to search inside a webpage, then receive accurate results in return.

The best practices to keep in mind when implementing a search bar in a webpage is to always include an input field and button in order for the user to easily find the search bar. Adding a call to action such as “Search Something” in the search bar and using a magnifying glass icon for the search button will communicate to the user that the specific component is a search bar. Moreover, it is important to ensure that the predicted results in a search bar will return accurate and efficient results.

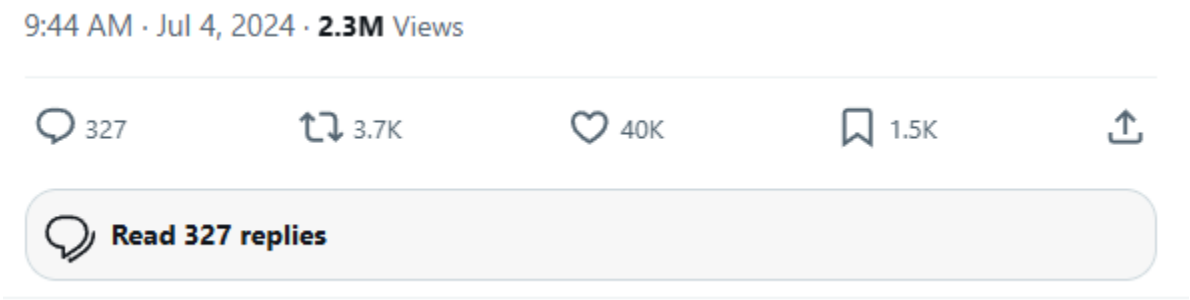


This is an example of a **good** illustration of a search bar. It is simple and easy to spot. Moreover, the magnifying glass button emphasizes and sends the message that this feature is a search bar.

5. Icons

Icons are small visuals that are utilized to communicate specific functions or features in a webpage. This allows the user to easily understand the use of a button or section of the website.

The best practices for using icons in a webpage is that the icons being used should be clear, simple, and easily understood.

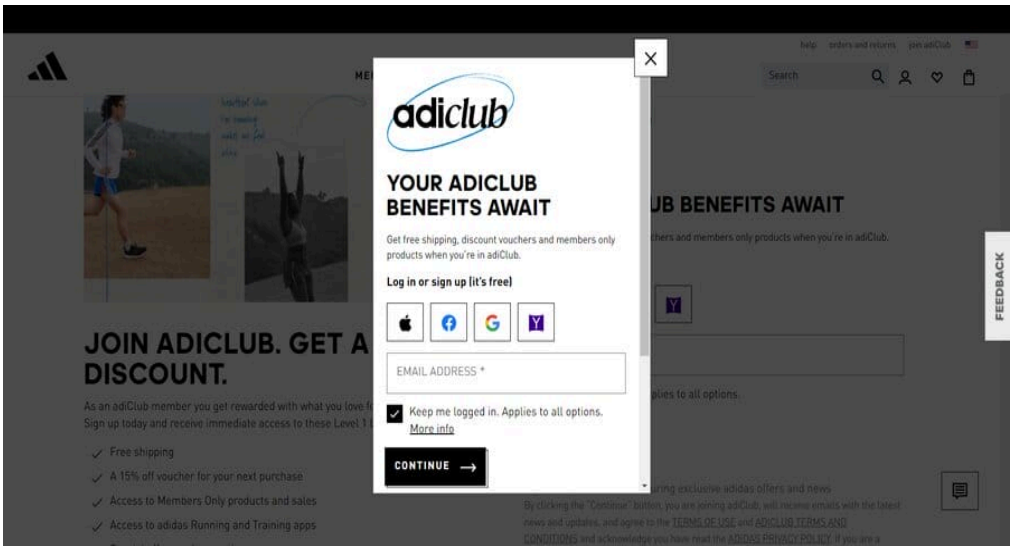


This example is a **good** illustration of icons in web design. The purpose of each button is easily understood due to the simple yet meaningful usage of the icons for the Comments, Retweet, Like, Bookmark, and Share buttons.

6. Modal

A modal is a dialog box that pops up over the main content of the webpage. This disables user interaction with the rest of the page until the modal that pops up is addressed. Moreover, modals are often used for: Forms, Newsletters, Announcements, Welcome Messages, and Confirmations.

Modals should not be overused, it should be used in a way that does not feel too pushy or aggressive towards the users as this can drive them away from the website. The modal should include a clear exit button in order for the user to have the ability to close the dialog box with ease.



This is an example of a **good** usage of a modal. It encourages a user to sign up to adidas' *adiclub* without being too overwhelming and pushy. The modal shown also provides the user with an option to easily close the popup.

7. Typography

Typography in a webpage refers to how all the elements of text in the page such as: sizes and spacing come together. It should look and feel cohesive in order for the webpage contents to be legible, understandable, and readable to the users.

A best practice in webpage typography is not using too many typefaces or fonts that are not compatible with one another. Using too many different types of fonts, especially when they do not create a cohesive look, can be overwhelming for the users and may look unappealing.

This example illustrates **bad** typography in web design. The call to action “Reach for your PEAK” almost blends in with the background, making it difficult to read. Moreover, the color choices for the text creates low contrast from the background, which fails to emphasize the part.

8. Colors

The use of specific colors in a website can communicate different meanings to users, and may also influence their experience while browsing the website. Moreover, the colors used in a webpage should convey meaning, grab attention, or establish the brand or identity of the website. Using cohesive and complementary colors will make the website appealing to look at, which results in good user experiences.

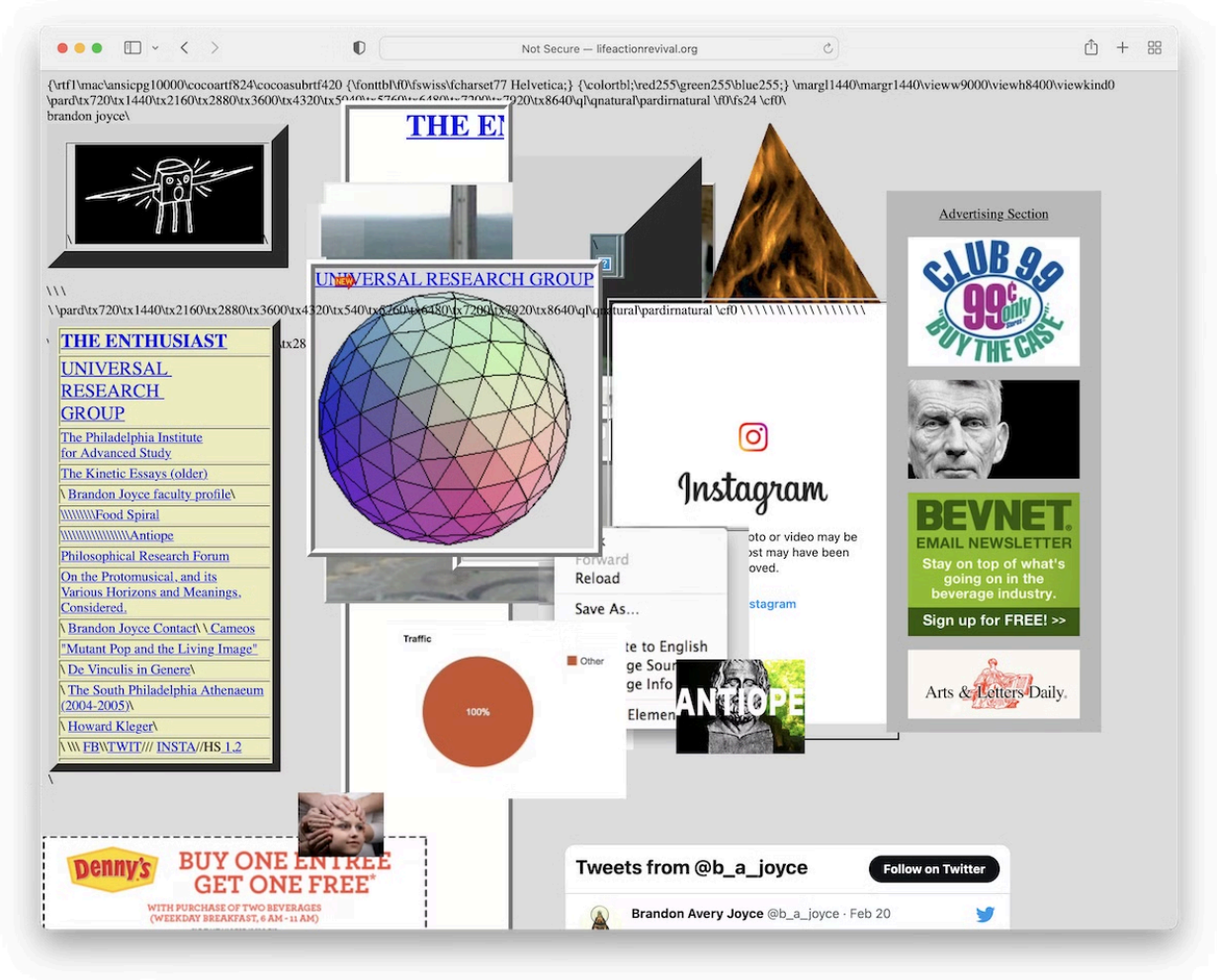
Best practices when using colors in web design is to use colors that work together, evoke appropriate emotions, or establish the identity of the site. Additionally, the chosen colors should be in harmony and are pleasant to look at.

This example illustrates a **badly** implemented color scheme in web design. The colors clash, and are too vibrant. Overall, the website is difficult to look at for long periods of time.

9. Usability

Usability refers to how easy users can interact with a website to accomplish their tasks efficiently and effectively. The website being designed should be intuitive, user friendly, and ensures a great user experience for the webpage visitors.

A best practice for implementing usability in web design is that the website should be easy to learn, and the website should be accessible to any type of user regardless of age, gender, race, or disability.

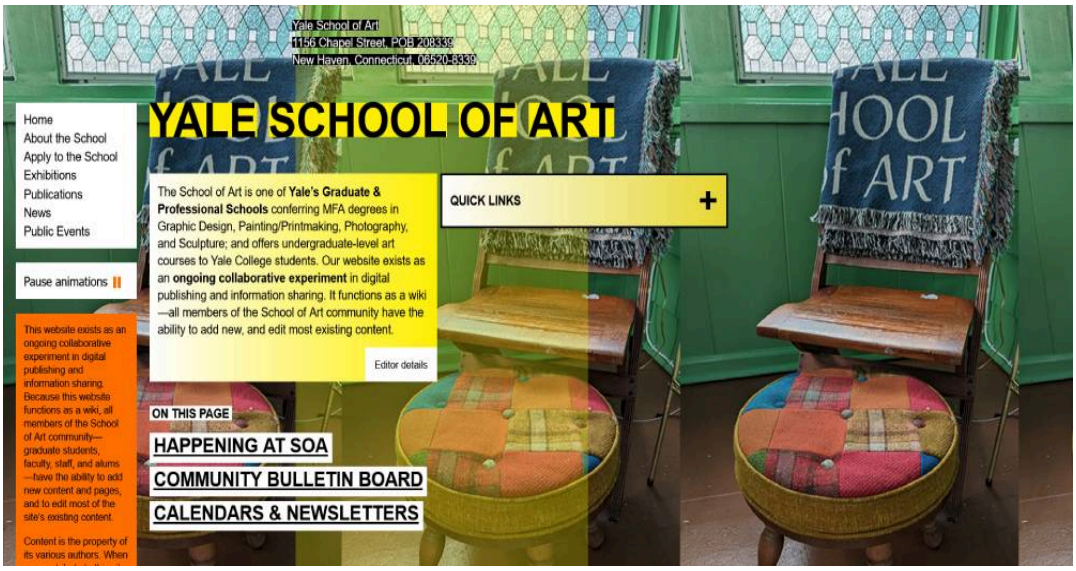


This example illustrates **bad** usability in web design. Upon entering the website, it is already difficult to figure out the purpose of the webpage, and it will be difficult for users to navigate through it.

10. Consistency

Consistency in web design refers to the uniformity and cohesiveness of a website. This allows users to have an enjoyable and easy experience while browsing and navigating through the webpages of the website.

Best practices to effectively implement consistency in web design is to not over-complicate the design, have cohesive color schemes throughout the webpages, and have a consistent navigation feature.



This example illustrates **bad** consistency within a webpage. The color schemes and typography vary and do not compliment each other. Moreover, the structure of the navigation features and the main content of the website are confusing which may be difficult for the users to understand.

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